



This manuscript illustration shows Charles VII entering Paris in triumph.

“THE KINGDOM OF FRANCE... WILL BE THUS RULED BY KING CHARLES VII... HE WILL ENTER PARIS IN GOOD COMPANY.”

Joan of Arc, Christian visionary

THOUGH ALLIED WITH THE ENGLISH OCCUPATION OF FRANCE, the Burgundians (see 1404–07) were increasingly concerned at English gains. With the **Treaty of Arras**, the Burgundians and the French king, Charles VII, made peace but the English, unwilling to accept the terms, withdrew from negotiations. The following year, the French alliance took Paris from English control.

The 1430s saw increasing **tension** between the **papacy** and the **conciliar movement**, which held that the Church ought to be governed by a Church council, rather than an individual pope. Pope Eugenius IV summoned a **General Council at Basel** in 1431, but it was dominated by **antipapal sentiment** and, in 1437, he tried to transfer the Council to Ferrara, where it would be more amenable to his influence. Most of the delegates refused to leave Basel, resulting in **two concurrent councils**.



Founded by King Henry VI of England, construction of Eton college was halted when the king was deposed during the War of the Roses.

IN 1438, **PACHACUTEC** (c. 1438–1472) BECAME THE NINTH INCA KING, or *Sapa Inca*. His reign heralded the beginning of a great expansion of the Inca realm, which had been confined to the immediate area around **Cuzco** since its foundation (see 1201–1205). It began with invasion by the rival Chancas, who besieged Cuzco, and were completely defeated. **Inca expansion** was facilitated by the sophisticated nature of most of the kingdoms and tribes they conquered; tight-knit, centralized administration focused on the emperor; a genius for organization and record-keeping (despite having no writing); and an imperial road-building program rivalled only by the Roman Empire.

In 1440, the young king of England founded a new college at Eton. The King's College of Our Lady of Eton near Windsor, now known as **Eton College**, was intended to be part of a large foundation including a massive church, an almshouse, and 70 scholars who were



KEY

- Expansion by 1400
- Expansion in the reign of Pachacutec

Inca expansion

The Inca Empire had expanded greatly between 1400 and the end of Pachacutec's reign. It would triple in size by the 16th century.

to receive free education before going on to King's College, Cambridge.

With the **Ottomans** (see 1286–90) occupying territories on all sides of the tiny remnants of the **Byzantine Empire**, and threatening Constantinople itself, the embattled Byzantine emperor John VIII Palaeologus (see 1448–49) arrived in Europe to plead for help from the **Council of Ferrara** in 1438.

Gold llama statuette

The Inca were so rich in gold that emperor Atahualpa was able to offer a ransom of 750 tons of it when captured by conquistadors in 1532.



Fresco by Domenico di Bartolo, (c. 1410–1461), of the Sienese school, from Siena's hospital of Santa Maria della Scala.

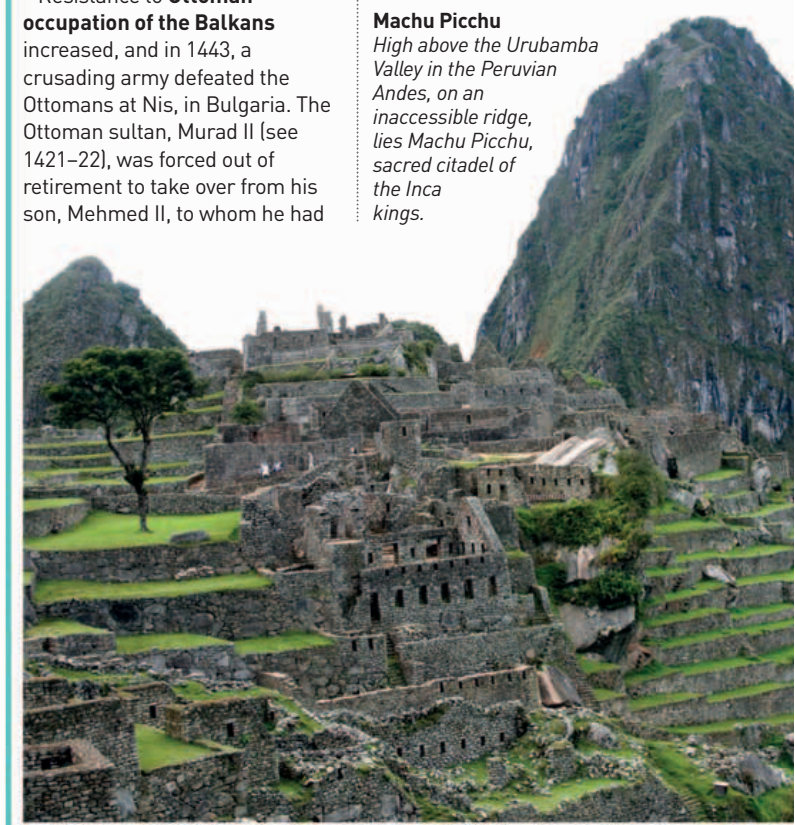
MACHU PICCHU (meaning “Old Peak” in Quechua, the language of the Incas) is a mountaintop citadel about 43 miles (70km) northwest of Cuzco. Construction probably began in the 1440s, under the auspices of **Pachacutec**. The maximum population of Machu Picchu was possibly only around 1,000, and it is thought that it served as a ceremonial center, as well as being an impregnable stronghold for the Inca elite in case of attack.

Resistance to **Ottoman occupation of the Balkans** increased, and in 1443, a crusading army defeated the Ottomans at Nis, in Bulgaria. The Ottoman sultan, Murad II (see 1421–22), was forced out of retirement to take over from his son, Mehmed II, to whom he had

attempted to entrust his crown. At Adrianople, Murad made a 10-year truce with Albanian military leader Hunyadi Skandebeg and other resisters of Ottoman advance. However, with the pope **preaching crusade**, the resisters were absolved of their oaths of peace and they launched a new attack. Led by Hunyadi and Wladyslaw III of Poland and Hungary (1424–1444), the crusading army—the last major

Machu Picchu

High above the Urubamba Valley in the Peruvian Andes, on an inaccessible ridge, lies Machu Picchu, sacred citadel of the Inca kings.



1435 Treaty of Arras; alliance of Burgundians with Charles VII of France against English

1436 Completion of Italian architect Filippo Brunelleschi's Duomo, Florence

December 9, 1437 Death of Emperor Sigismund (b. 1388)

1437 Civil war in Scotland

1437 Moors retake Ceuta, North Africa

1438 Byzantine emperor John VIII Palaeologus arrives at Council of Ferrara to seek help against Ottomans

1438 Expansion of Inca Empire begins under Sapa Inca Pachacutec

1439 Council of Basel deposes Pope Eugene IV; elects anti-pope Felix V

1439 Oba Ewuare takes power in Benin Empire, West Africa

c. 1440s Construction of Machu Picchu, Inca Empire, begins

1438 Francesco Sforza acting for Venice defeats Milanese mercenaries

1439 Ottoman sultan Murad II (1404–51) begins conquest of Serbia

1440 Henry VI founds Eton College, England

1440 Moctezuma I Aztec emperor and expands dominion

1441 Francesco Sforza negotiates Treaty of Cavriana between Venice and Milan

1441 Mayan city of Mayapan destroyed in revolt, Central America

1442 Death of Alexander I the Great (b. 1386), who reunited Georgia